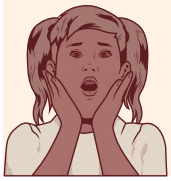
Surprise surprise!!



Warm-up: What Surprises You?

What kinds of things generally surprise you? Think about recent events, personal experiences, or even just general observations.

- Do you like surprises? Why / why not?
- What was the last surprise you had?
- Are you good at keeping secrets?

Key Vocabulary

- **Astonished:** Very surprised; amazed.
- **Flabbergasted:** Utterly astonished or surprised.
- **Unexpected:** Not expected or predicted.
- **Out of the blue:** Happening suddenly and unexpectedly.

Useful Expressions

- **I didn’t see it coming.**
- **It was totally unexpected.**
- **I had no idea.**
- **I was really shocked.**
- **It made my day.**
- **I couldn’t believe it.**
- **It was a nice / horrible surprise.**
- **I wasn’t prepared for it.**

Useful Sentences for Discussion

Talking about experiences

- **The biggest surprise I’ve ever had was…**
- **I was surprised when…**
- **I didn’t expect that at all.**

Expressing feelings

- **It made me feel happy / nervous / uncomfortable.**
- **At first I felt…, but then…**
- **My first reaction was…**

Giving opinions

- **I think surprises are…**
- **In my opinion, it's better to…**
- **Personally, I prefer…**

Reacting to others

- **That's interesting because…**
- **I feel the same way.**
- **I don't really agree.**
- **I would react differently.**

Questions for Discussion

1. What is the biggest surprise you've ever experienced?
2. Can surprises be good or bad? Provide examples.
3. Has anyone ever surprised you in a bad way?
4. Have you ever planned a surprise for someone else? How did it go?
5. Have you ever ruined a surprise?
6. Do you think people from different cultures react to surprises in the same way? Why or why not?
7. What's the difference between a surprise and a coincidence?
8. Is it better to be prepared for everything, or to embrace the unexpected?
9. Is it better to give a surprise or receive one?
10. Are surprises important in relationships?
11. Are surprises more for children or adults?
12. If someone planned a surprise holiday for you, where would you like to go?
13. What would be the worst possible surprise for you?
14. If you could surprise anyone in the world, who would it be?
15. What surprise would completely change your life?
16. What kind of surprise would make you uncomfortable?

Role-Playing: Reacting to Surprises

Case 1 – The Surprise Party

Your friends organise a big surprise party for your birthday.
They invite many people, including some you don't know very well.

You were planning a quiet evening at home.

Discuss:

- How would you feel?
- Would you be happy or annoyed?
- How would you react in front of your friends?
- Is this a good or bad surprise for you?

Case 2 – The Surprise Job Offer

You receive an unexpected job offer in another city or country.
The job is interesting, but you didn't plan to move.

Discuss:

- What would be your first reaction?
- Would you accept or refuse?
- What would you be worried about?
- How would this surprise change your life?

Surprise Endings & Plot Twists

Think of your favorite movie, book, or TV show. Does it have a surprising ending or a significant plot twist? Tell the class about it, but don't give away *too* much detail (no spoilers)! Explain why the twist was effective and how it impacted the story.

Discuss: What makes a good plot twist or surprise ending?